

KINDERGARTEN READINESS CHECKLIST

A simple guide to help families feel prepared for kindergarten



Emotional Readiness

- ☐ Handles small frustrations without shutting down
- ☐ Separates from parent with reassurance
- ☐ Transitions between activities with reminders
- ☐ Expresses feelings with words (happy, sad, angry)
- ☐ Calms down with adult support



Social Skills

- ☐ Takes turns in games and conversations
- ☐ Shares toys and materials with other children
- ☐ Listens when others are speaking
- ☐ Plays alongside or with other children
- ☐ Asks for help when needed



Independence & Self-Care

- ☐ Uses the bathroom independently (or with minimal help)
- ☐ Washes hands and face without reminding
- ☐ Puts on shoes and jacket with some help
- ☐ Cleans up toys when asked
- ☐ Eats and drinks independently



Communication & Language

- ☐ Understands simple, multi-step directions
- ☐ Speaks in sentences (not just single words)
- ☐ Asks questions to understand new things
- ☐ Tells simple stories about their day
- ☐ Follows along when being read to



Focus & Attention

- ☐ Sits for a short story (5-10 minutes)
- ☐ Completes one activity before moving to another
- ☐ Focuses on a task with gentle reminders
- ☐ Responds to their name
- ☐ Follows a familiar routine



Fine Motor Skills

- ☐ Begins to hold writing tools with some finger control
- ☐ Scribbles and attempts to copy shapes
- ☐ Turns pages in a book
- ☐ Stacks blocks or toys
- ☐ Uses utensils to eat



Curiosity & Learning Readiness

- ☐ Shows interest in books and stories
- ☐ Asks "why" and "how" questions
- ☐ Tries new activities even if uncertain
- ☐ Enjoys singing, dancing, and playing
- ☐ Observes and explores their environment



Parent Note: This checklist is not a pass-or-fail test. It's a snapshot to help you understand where your child is developmentally and what you can nurture at home.



Every child grows at their own pace. You're doing a great job! ❤️

